Portfolio Website: Project Brief

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Overview

A personal portfolio website to present Sandeep's work, organized by category so visitors can quickly find the kind of project they care about. The site pairs detailed UI/UX case studies with a visual collection of creative work, in a black and white premium style with playful touches.

Goals (proposed)

- Show UI/UX work in depth through case studies that explain process and outcomes
- Present creative work by category in a browsable, image-first collection
- Make it easy to download the resume and get in touch
- Express a distinctive, premium personal brand through the design itself

Audience

The primary visitors are hiring managers and recruiters, and the main goal of the site is to get Sandeep hired in a full-time role. Clients and design peers are secondary.

Site structure

Page	Purpose
Home	Introduction and highlights, with equal weight on UI/UX case studies and creative work
UI/UX Projects	Detailed case studies
Creative Works	Visual design collection
About	Story, skills and experience
Resume	Downloadable CV
Contact	Email and social links

Creative Works categories

- Brand Identity
- Social Media Creatives
- Digital Artwork
- Posters & Campaigns
- Motion & Video
- Other Explorations

Design direction

- **Mood:** black and white premium with playful touches (the Playful Monochrome direction)
- **Palette:** ink, white and silver, with one red accent used sparingly for errors and a single key action
- **Titles:** clean solid type with no red shadow
- **Typography:** Syne for display and headings, Space Grotesk for body and interface text
- **Imagery:** project work supplies the only color on the page
- **Themes:** light and dark

Design system (in progress)

The design system is the foundation for every page:
https://claude.ai/artifact/CZJFxarbWdKrEUzBJR99WG

It currently covers:

- Color tokens, split into primitive and semantic tiers, with light and dark values and contrast pairings
- Typography with pixel values and Figma-ready specs, including a fixed Display XL (224px size, 190px line height, -4% letter spacing)
- Spacing, radius, borders, shadows and motion
- Core components: buttons, forms, badges, cards, navigation, feedback, modal and data display
- Portfolio components: section cards, category filter, case study card, creative tile, case study page template, lightbox, resume and contact links, and footer

Key features (proposed)

- Category filtering on Creative Works

- Case study template with a cover, a facts row (role, timeline, tools, outcome), then problem, process and results
- Lightbox for creative pieces, with video support for Motion & Video
- Resume PDF download and contact links
- Responsive layout, keyboard-accessible, with text contrast meeting WCAG AA in both themes

Deliverables

1. Design system (in progress)
2. Home page design
3. UI/UX Projects listing and case study template
4. Creative Works listing with category filter and lightbox
5. About, Resume and Contact pages
6. Built and published website

Success criteria (proposed)

- A visitor can reach any project within two clicks from Home
- Every case study explains the problem, the process and the outcome
- The site works well on mobile and desktop
- Text meets AA contrast in light and dark themes

Open questions

- Which two or three projects should lead on Home for UI/UX, and which for creative work?
- What is the target launch date?
- How many projects are in each category, and which are featured on Home?
- Will the site be designed in Figma first and then built, or built directly?
- Where will it be hosted, and is a domain already chosen?
- Display XL is a fixed 224px, so what size should the headline use on mobile?

Research and discovery (proposed)

The aim is to ground the portfolio's content, structure and design in what visitors actually need, before the pages are built.

Research questions

- Who visits a designer's portfolio, and what do they look for in the first minute?
- Which projects best prove range across UI/UX and visual design?
- What do strong portfolios in this space do well, and where do they fall short?
- What content already exists for each category, and what is missing?

Activities

Activity	What it involves	Output
Audience definition	Name the primary and secondary visitors (hiring managers, clients, peers) and the one action each should take	Audience profiles and the primary call to action
Positioning interview	Capture the roles being targeted, the story the site should tell, and what sets the work apart	Positioning statement
Portfolio review	Study 8 to 10 portfolios from product and visual designers: structure, case study depth, navigation and tone	Patterns to adopt and avoid
Content audit	List every project with its category, role, year, available assets and strength	Project inventory and featured shortlist
Visitor feedback	Show the site structure and a first page to 3 to 5 people from the target audience and ask where they would click and what is unclear	Findings and structure fixes
Technical discovery	Decide the build approach, hosting, analytics, and performance and accessibility targets	Technical decisions

Outputs

- Audience profiles and the primary call to action
- Positioning statement
- Project inventory with featured projects chosen
- Portfolio review notes with a do and avoid list

- Confirmed site structure

Suggested timeline

One to two weeks, finishing before page design begins.

Research findings: portfolio review

A review of current guidance on designer portfolios and what hiring managers and recruiters look for. Most sources are blogs and vendor guides, so treat the figures as directional.

Key findings

- **Visitors decide fast.** Initial scans are short, with one guide citing 6 to 8 seconds, and reviewers rarely read case studies word for word. The strongest work needs to come first. (ResumeGeni, NN/g)
- **Depth beats volume.** Two to four strong projects are enough, and hiring managers typically expect two to three case studies. (UXfolio, UX Design Institute)
- **Case studies need a clear structure.** The problem, the solution and the outcome are the core. Communication, storytelling and process rank high with design managers and recruiters. (Kalibrr Design, UX Collective)
- **Distinctiveness matters.** Templates make portfolios look alike. Most use a white background, so black stands out, and generous whitespace appears in nearly every strong example. (Adobe Design, UXfolio)
- **Creative work is organized by type.** Categories help visitors navigate and show range. Motion portfolios often lead with a reel and label the role and year on each project. (Wix, Colorlib)
- **Speed and ownership count.** Use your own domain, load fast, look clean on mobile, and avoid gated access. (ResumeGeni)

Implications for the site

- **Home:** feature 3 to 5 of the best projects, each with a one-line outcome
- **UI/UX Projects:** aim for 2 to 4 deep case studies, with a problem, solution and outcome summary at the top of the case study template
- **Creative Works:** keep the category filter, show role and year on every piece, and lead Motion & Video with a reel
- **Design:** the black and white premium direction suits the findings, so keep pages light for fast loading

- **Resume and Contact:** reachable in one click from every page

Next research steps

- Content audit of existing projects
- Audience definition and positioning interview
- Visitor feedback on the site structure